JUDE

Conversational Version

Salutation

1Jude, servant of Jesus Christ[Messiah] and brother of James, to the ones called by God the Father, loves and keeps you in Jesus Christ. **2**Mercy, peace, and love many times over.

Condemnation of False Teachers

3Friends, I'm anxious to write to you about the salvation we share. I need to encourage you to keep contending earnestly for the faith once and for all delivered to the saints. **4**Ungodly people have sneaked in under false pretenses; long ago they were assigned to that condemnation. They deny Jesus Christ as our only Master and Lord and try to pervert God's grace into lustful living.

5You know that once and for all, but I want to remind you that after the LORD saved a people out of Egypt, he destroyed the ones that didn't trust *him*. **6**Angels that didn't keep their place he has held under darkness in permanent bonds till the great judgment day. **7**Likewise, Sodom and Gomorrah and the cities around them lived immorally, going after other flesh. They serve as examples of being subjected to eternal punishment by fire. **Jude 1-7**

Describing Some False Teachers

8Yet in like manner such people even fantasize about defiling the flesh, rejecting authority, and railing at angels. **9**But when Michael the archangel was arguing with the devil about the body of Moses, he didn't bring railing condemnation; he said, *"The LORD reprimand you."* **10**People like them rail out about what they don't understand, about what they know by instinct like animals that can't reason—and therefore destroy themselves. **11**What consequences await them! They've followed Cain's way; they've plunged into Balaam's deception for money; they've perished in Korah's rebellion. **12**They're hidden pieces of gravel in your love-feast *food*; without qualms they carouse among *you*, shepherding themselves. They're clouds with no moisture, driven around by the wind. *They're* late autumn trees with no fruit, uprooted, and doubly dead. **13***They're* wild waves of the sea, foaming up shameful acts. *They're* stars out of orbit that the gloom of darkness is reserved for. **Jude 8-13**

14Enoch, the seventh from Adam, prophesied about them, *"The LORD will come with 10,000 holy ones* **15***to convict sinners of their ungodly deeds and terrible blasphemies against him."* **16**They grumble, complain, pursue lusts, talk arrogantly, flatter people for gain. **Jude 14-16**

Maintaining Faithfulness Despite Competition

17But dear friends, remember what the apostles of our Lord Jesus Christ **18**used to tell you, *"In the end mockers will come, chasing after ungodly lusts.* **19***They'll be divisive,*

materialistic, unspiritual." **20**But you, build yourselves up with your most holy faith and with prayer in the Holy Spirit. **21**Keep yourselves in God's love and wait for the mercy of our Lord Jesus Christ, who brings eternal life. **22**Have mercy on some that doubt; **23**save some by snatching them out of the fire; have mercy on others cautiously, hating even their clothes stained by the flesh.

Jude 17-23

Benediction

24Now to him who can keep you from stumbling and stand you blameless in front of his glory with great joy, **25**to the only God our Savior through Jesus Christ our Lord *be* glory and majesty, dominion and authority before all time, now, and forever. Amen. **Jude 24-25**

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